

100BaseT

A synonym for the Fast Ethernet networking standard. The ‘100’ here refers to the maximum data transfer rate of 100 Mbps over twisted-pair wiring.

10BaseT

A synonym for the Ethernet networking standard. The ‘10’ here refers to the maximum data transfer rate of 10 Mbps over twisted-pair wiring.

3DES

The three-DES data encryption standard. This is a three-step data encryption algorithm that evolved from DES. 3DES provides greater security than DES because it encrypts, decrypts, and then again encrypts the data, thus using three keys instead of one. The size of a 3DES key is also three times larger—168 bits, as against the 56 bits for DES.

802.11

A set of IEEE standards for data transmission over wireless LANs (WLANs). The specifications within 802.11 include 802.11, 802.11a, 802.11b, and 802.11g. All these use the Ethernet protocol. 802.11 describes a WLAN that operates in the 2.4 GHz range and provides a data transmission rate of 1 Mbps or 2 Mbps using spread-spectrum technology.

802.11a

This describes a WLAN that operates in the 5 GHz range, and provides a data throughput of up to 54 Mbps. It uses orthogonal frequency division multiplexing (OFDM) technology. The 5 GHz range is less crowded with devices than the 2.4 GHz range, so there is less risk of interference.

802.11b

The most widespread WLAN standard. It describes a WLAN that operates in the 2.4 GHz range with a data throughput of up to 11 Mbps using spread-spectrum technology. This specification